

Finance Committee Meeting September 9th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=u2K8lg-q2NM
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Target Category	muncie_city

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City Council Finance Committee Working Session Meeting Summary

Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The third working session of the City Council Finance Committee was called to order by the presiding officer [00:00:25](#). The presiding officer noted that the meeting was a working session focused on receiving information from department heads and that public comments would not be taken during this session [00:01:11](#).
- **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening remarks.
- **Members Present:** Selby, McIntosh, Green, Garrett, Sasha, Mason, and other council members (roll call noted members present [00:00:52](#)).
- **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.

Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The committee rose for the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer [00:00:30](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not discussed during this working session.

Substantive Business & Board Action

1. 00:01:51 Street Department Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Adam Leech, City Engineer / Director of Public Works 00:02:08.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Reviewed local roads and streets, capital projects, and motor vehicle highway (MVH) funds for the 2025 and 2026 budgets.
 - Discussed a \$1.3 million reduction in capital projects, which Mr. Leech explained was a placeholder dependent on federal project timing and matching fund requirements (e.g., Fulson, Megard, and Columbus Avenue projects) 00:03:32.
 - Noted a duplication error in the proposed budget where "Other services and charges" and "Capital projects" were listed twice 00:04:12.
 - Discussed the consolidation of positions into single line items to provide operational flexibility under union contracts 00:05:02.
 - Reviewed overtime usage (largely driven by winter snow removal between January and March) 00:07:40, equipment repair parts costs 00:09:01, CDL training costs for staff 00:10:32, and the purchase of a new sign printer 00:12:19.
 - Addressed a 2023 State Board of Accounts (SBOA) audit finding regarding the use of MVH restricted funds for certain salaries and operational expenses, with council emphasizing the need for strict compliance with state code 00:17:07.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None (public comments restricted during working sessions).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review only; no formal vote recorded.

2. 00:20:02 Parks Department Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Park Superintendent 00:20:13.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Reviewed the 2025 and 2026 parks budgets, summer recreation funding adjustments 00:20:51, and swim program funding handled via outside grants and the Cardinal Swim Club 00:21:43.
 - Discussed the completed skate park project and rules/oversight regarding vandalism 00:22:51.
 - Highlighted an increase in miscellaneous revenue/receipts 00:25:05 and the successful revenue generation of the newly renovated lodge at McCullough Park 00:25:43.
 - Commended park leadership for restoring working lights at Heinen Park 00:26:47.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review only; no formal vote recorded.

3. 00:27:53 Prairie Creek Reservoir Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Marshall 00:28:21.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Discussed line-item shifts for part-time guards and security staff 00:29:02, reductions in mowing equipment capital expenditures 00:29:43, and an estimated decrease in miscellaneous revenue of approximately \$139,000 00:29:58.
 - Addressed potential impacts on capital projects, such as floating docks and shelter/campground improvements 00:30:44.
 - Noted the suspension of horseback riding and off-road trails due to landowner (water company) decisions 00:31:40.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review only; no formal vote recorded.

4. 00:33:33 Beach Grove Cemetery Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cemetery representative / management.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Clarified a decrease in the alarm system line item, explaining that the prior year's budget covered initial equipment purchase (cameras/system), whereas the new budget reflects quarterly service fees 00:34:08.
 - Discussed tool allowances reflecting contract updates 00:37:18, non-reverting unemployment funds 00:38:22, and increased parts costs for aging lawnmowers 00:39:09.
 - Highlighted in-house historic fence repairs resulting in significant cost savings compared to contractor quotes 00:39:58.
 - Discussed community foundation grant funds used for historic road naming and signage projects within the cemetery 00:41:41.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review only; no formal vote recorded.

5. 00:47:06 Administrative Discussion: Department Head Salaries & Budget Formulas

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Wright (Administration) and Council Members 00:47:06.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Reviewed discrepancies and calculations regarding proposed department head salary increases relative to adopted 2025 budgets (incorporating prior 1% adjustments, 4% adjustments, and proposed 4% increases).
 - Emphasized the need for all council members to utilize consistent formulas and coordinate questions through shared emails ahead of the upcoming committee meeting 00:53:51.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion; no formal vote recorded.
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Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: The presiding officer explicitly stated at the outset of the meeting that public comment would not be taken during this working session, noting that public comment occurred at a prior public hearing and will be welcomed at the final finance committee meeting on the 23rd 00:01:11.

Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Reminded finance committee members to copy all colleagues on emailed questions sent to the administration 00:53:51.
 - Noted the final finance committee meeting is scheduled for the 23rd 00:01:34.
 - **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made and seconded 00:54:12; the meeting was concluded for the night.
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